

RONG ZHANG

rongzhang@tamu.edu, 979-319-0360

Personal Website: <https://rongzhang123.github.io/>

EDUCATION

- Texas A&M University** *2021 - Expected 2027*
PhD Candidate in Agricultural Economics
- Texas A&M University** *2019 - 2021*
Master of Science in Economics
Major: Financial Econometrics, GPA: 4.0/4.0
- University of International Business and Economics, China** *2015 - 2019*
B.A. in Economics
Major: International Economics and Trade

RESEARCH AREA

- Research Fields:** Empirical Industrial Organization, Applied Microeconomics
- Research Interests:** Consumer Demand, Pricing and Product Differentiation, Food Retail, Household Behavior and Inequality

WORKING PAPERS

- Price Discrimination, Product Differentiation, and Gender-Based Pricing in Consumer Packaged Goods**
with Yvette Zhang
Revise and Resubmit (2nd round), Southern Economic Journal
- Educational Assortative Matching and Income Inequality in China**
with Song Zhou and Yvette Zhang
Under Review
- Economies of Scale, Product Composition, and Vertical Pricing in Food Retail**
with Mengjie Li and Yvette Zhang

RESEARCH REPORT

- Techno-Economic Analysis and Life Cycle Assessment of an Energy-Efficient Lignocellulosic Pulping Platform** (in preparation)
USDA-NIFA funded research project, collaborated with Michigan State University

WORK IN PROGRESS

- When Lipstick Effect Meets Engel's Law: How Do Households Reallocate Spending across Economic Cycles?**
with Lingxiao Wang, Wenying Li and Yvette Zhang
- Powering AI: Data Centers and Electricity Market Outcomes**

CONFERENCES AND PRESENTATION

AEA Annual Meeting (ASSA)

Scheduled Paper Presentation, Jan 2027

Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Meeting

Scheduled Paper Presentation, Nov 2026

American Agricultural Economics Association (AAEA) Annual Conference

Paper Presentation, July 2026; Poster Presentation, July 2025

Chinese Economists Society (CES) North America Annual Conference

Paper Presentation, March 2025

Southern Agricultural Economics Association (SAEA) Annual Meeting

Paper Presentation, February 2026

Symposium for Agricultural & Applied Economics Research

Paper Presentation, April 2025 & March 2026

Food Health & Applied Group Seminar, TAMU

Paper Presentation, December 2024 & February 2025

Econometrics Study Group, TAMU

Paper Presentation, August 2025

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Research Tutor

INTA Capstone Research Course, Master of International Affairs Students

Teaching Assistant

AGEC 105 Introduction to Agricultural Economics

AGEC 625 Environment of Agribusiness (graduate level)

AGEC 350 Environmental and Natural Resource Economics

AGEC 440 Agribusiness Strategic Analysis

AGEC 325 Principles of Farm and Ranch Management

AGEC 431 Cases in Agribusiness Finance

AGEC 340 Agribusiness Management

RESEARCH AND WORK EXPERIENCE

Department of Agricultural Economics, TAMU

July 2025- December 2025

Research Assistant for Dr. Yvette Zhang

Department of Economics, TAMU

April 2021-April 2023

Research Assistant for Dr. Li Gan

Department of Agricultural Economics, TAMU

January 2022-August 2022

Research Assistant for Dr. Jean-Claude Bizimana

The Bush School of Government & Public Service, TAMU

December 2020-June 2022

Research Assistant for Dr. Ren Mu

CoronaNet Research Group

Volunteer Research Assistant

June 2020 - August 2020

China Development Research Foundation

Economics Research Intern

May 2019 – September 2019

GRANTS AND AWARDS

Research Assistantship, USDA-NIFA Grant, Summer & Fall 2025 & Summer 2026

Graduate Assistantship, Department of Agricultural Economics, TAMU, Fall 2022 - Spring 2025

Graduate Scholarship, Department of Economics, TAMU, Fall 2019 – Spring 2021

Travel Grant, Graduate Students' Association (GSA), TAMU, Spring & Summer 2025, Summer 2026

SERVICE

Referee, Applied Economic Perspectives and Policy, 2026

Technical Support, SAEA Annual Meeting, 2026

Treasurer, Graduate Student Organization, TAMU, 2024-2025

Organizer, Food Health and Applied Group Meetings, AgEcon Department, TAMU, 2024

SKILLS

Programming: R, Python, Stata, GAMS

Methods: Discrete Choice Models, BLP Demand Estimation, Demand Systems, IV/GMM, Panel Data, Counterfactual Simulation

Other: LaTeX, openLCA

Languages: Chinese (Native), English (Fluent)

REFERENCES

Dr. Yvette Zhang (Chair)

Professor

Agricultural Economics

Texas A&M University

Email: yzhang@tamu.edu

Dr. Ximing Wu (Co-Chair)

Professor

Agricultural Economics

Texas A&M University

Email: xwu@email.tamu.edu

Dr. Li Gan (Committee Member)

Professor

Economics

Texas A&M University

Email: ganli@tamu.edu

Dr. Desmond Ng (Teaching)

Associate Professor

Agricultural Economics

Texas A&M University

Email: desmond.ng@ag.tamu.edu